

10: Sampling Distributions with StatKey

Stat 120 | Spring 2026

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i No R needed today! We'll focus on concepts and intuition with StatKey

1. Use StatKey's **mean** menu: https://www.lock5stat.com/StatKey/sampling_1_quant/sampling_1_quant.html and select "Percent with internet access 3e (countries)". Click "Show data table".
 - (a) What is each case?
 - (b) What is each variable?
 - (c) Do you think this dataset represents a population or a sample?
 - (d) Close the dataset viewer. Click "Generate 10 samples". What does each dot represent?
 - (e) What happens to the shape, center, and spread of the sampling distribution as n increases? (You can use "Generate 1000 samples" to speed this up)
 - (f) Is there a number of samples where the distribution doesn't change much?
2. Use StatKey's **proportion** menu: https://www.lock5stat.com/StatKey/sampling_1_cat/sampling_1_cat.html to answer the following.
 - (a) Click the "edit proportion" button to change the population parameter p
 - (b) Choose a value of p that is between .2 and .8. Describe how the shape, center, and spread of the sampling distribution changes as n increases
 - (c) Now, choose a large n and keep it constant. Describe how the shape, center, and spread of the sampling distribution changes as p gets closer to 1
3. About 10% of the worldwide population is left-handed. A 200-seat lecture hall has been built with 15 rows (the number of seats in each row varies). Each row has a single "lefty seat" that has the built-in desk on the left rather than the right arm of the chair. In a class of 90 students, what's the probability that there will not be enough seats for the left-handed students?
 - (a) What number of left-handed students would have to be in the class for there to not be enough desks?
 - (b) Set up the sampling distribution using StatKey. What is p and n ?
 - (c) Simulate 1000 samples. Use the results to estimate the probability.

- (d) Now suppose there's a class of 50 instead. Do you think this probability will be higher, lower, or about the same as (d)?
 - (e) Use StatKey to estimate the probability in (d). Are you surprised?
4. Explain the difference between (1) the distribution of a population, (2) the distribution of a sample, (3) the sampling distribution. Be sure to fill in these definitions in your note sheet.

When you're done, submit the answers to number 3 on gradescope. You only need to submit 1 per group.